

Meridian & Associates LLP

Global Professional Services

Global Delivery Network

Version 2.5

Effective Date: January 2026

Classification: Confidential

Prepared by the Office of Strategic Communications

Meridian & Associates LLP

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1. Delivery Network Overview

Meridian's Global Delivery Network (GDN) comprises 11 delivery centers across 6 countries, employing over 14,000 professionals who provide scalable, cost-effective, and high-quality service delivery to clients worldwide. The GDN is a core strategic asset that enables Meridian to offer blended delivery models combining onshore expertise with nearshore and offshore capacity, delivering savings of 30-40% compared to fully onshore delivery without compromising quality or security.

The GDN operates as an integrated extension of our onshore teams, sharing the same methodologies, quality standards, security protocols, and career development frameworks. Every delivery center is ISO 27001 certified and operates under Meridian's global Information Security Policy and Data Privacy Policy.

2. Nearshore Delivery Centers

Nearshore centers provide time-zone-aligned delivery for Americas and European clients, combining cost efficiency with real-time collaboration capabilities.

2.1 San Jose, Costa Rica

- Established: 2016. Headcount: 1,400 professionals.
- Time zone: CST (UTC-6) -- aligned with U.S. Eastern and Central time zones.
- Capabilities: Application development, cloud engineering, data analytics, cybersecurity operations, service desk (English and Spanish bilingual).
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, CMMI Level 5.
- Key advantage: 1-2 hour time zone overlap with all U.S. time zones; strong bilingual talent pool; stable business environment ranked #1 in Latin America for ease of doing business.

2.2 Warsaw, Poland

- Established: 2018 (expanded 2024). Headcount: 1,800 professionals.
- Time zone: CET (UTC+1) -- aligned with Western European clients.
- Capabilities: Cloud migration (AWS, Azure, GCP), data engineering, SAP, ServiceNow, RPA/intelligent automation, cybersecurity, financial advisory support.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, ISO 22301.
- Key advantage: EU data residency compliance; access to deep STEM talent pool from 20+ Polish technical universities; multilingual (Polish, English, German, French common).

2.3 Bucharest, Romania

- Established: 2020. Headcount: 1,200 professionals.
- Time zone: EET (UTC+2) -- serves both Western and Eastern European clients.
- Capabilities: Software engineering, QA/testing, data science and ML engineering, DevOps, technical documentation.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II.
- Key advantage: Competitive cost structure (20-25% below Warsaw); strong engineering talent; EU membership ensuring data sovereignty compliance.

2.4 Cluj-Napoca, Romania

- Established: 2023. Headcount: 150 professionals.
- Time zone: EET (UTC+2) -- complements Bucharest operations.
- Capabilities: Software engineering, automated testing, DevSecOps, data pipeline development.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II.
- Key advantage: Access to strong technical university talent pool (Babes-Bolyai University, Technical University of Cluj-Napoca); supplements Bucharest capacity for EU-compliant delivery.

2.5 Guadalajara, Mexico

- Established: 2024. Headcount: 100 professionals.
- Time zone: CST (UTC-6) -- aligned with U.S. Central and Mountain time zones.
- Capabilities: Application development, cloud engineering, data analytics, bilingual service desk (English and Spanish).
- Certifications: ISO 27001 (in progress; expected Q2 2026).
- Key advantage: Strong STEM talent from Universidad de Guadalajara and ITESO; nearshore alternative to Costa Rica with competitive cost structure; supports growing Latin American client base.

3. Offshore Delivery Centers

Offshore centers provide maximum cost efficiency and access to deep talent pools for large-scale delivery programs.

3.1 India -- Bangalore

- Established: 2008. Headcount: 3,400 professionals (largest delivery center).
- Capabilities: Full-stack development, enterprise platform implementation (SAP, Salesforce, Workday, Oracle), data engineering, AI/ML, cloud infrastructure, testing/QA.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, CMMI Level 5, ISO 20000.
- Specializations: Center of Excellence for SAP S/4HANA and Data & AI.

3.2 India -- Hyderabad

- Established: 2012. Headcount: 2,200 professionals.
- Capabilities: Cybersecurity operations (managed SOC), infrastructure managed services, application support, ERP managed services, cloud operations.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, ISO 20000, PCI DSS.
- Specializations: Center of Excellence for Managed Security Services and Cloud Operations.

3.3 India -- Chennai

- Established: 2014. Headcount: 1,800 professionals.
- Capabilities: Finance and accounting operations, regulatory technology, risk analytics, internal audit support, testing and quality assurance.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II.
- Specializations: Center of Excellence for Financial Services delivery and RegTech.

3.4 Philippines -- Manila

- Established: 2017. Headcount: 1,600 professionals.
- Capabilities: Business process operations, customer experience, content management, healthcare revenue cycle, finance and accounting, HR operations.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, HITRUST (healthcare operations).
- Key advantage: Native English proficiency; strong cultural alignment with U.S. and Australian clients; competitive cost (35-40% below onshore).

3.5 India -- Pune

- Established: 2022. Headcount: 200 professionals.
- Capabilities: Cloud-native application development, microservices architecture, API engineering, and mobile development.
- Certifications: ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II.
- Specializations: Emerging technology incubator for cloud-native and edge computing solutions; supplements Bangalore capacity for high-demand technology engagements.

3.6 Philippines -- Cebu

- Established: 2023. Headcount: 150 professionals.
- Capabilities: Business process operations, document processing, data entry and validation, quality assurance, customer support operations.
- Certifications: ISO 27001 (in progress; expected Q3 2026).
- Key advantage: Lower cost structure than Manila (10-15% savings); strong English proficiency; growing IT talent pool from University of San Carlos and Cebu Institute of Technology.

4. Blended Rate Model and Cost Savings

Meridian's blended delivery model combines onshore engagement leadership and client-facing expertise with nearshore and offshore delivery capacity. Typical blended ratios and savings:

- Standard Blend (Advisory): 50% onshore / 20% nearshore / 30% offshore. Savings: 20-25% vs fully onshore.
- Optimized Blend (Technology Delivery): 25% onshore / 25% nearshore / 50% offshore. Savings: 30-35% vs fully onshore.
- Maximum Efficiency Blend (Managed Services): 15% onshore / 15% nearshore / 70% offshore. Savings: 35-40% vs fully onshore.
- Nearshore Premium: Nearshore rates are typically 15-20% above offshore rates but 25-30% below onshore rates, offering a balanced value proposition.

Blended rates are calculated transparently based on the team composition defined in each SOW. Clients receive visibility into the onshore/nearshore/offshore mix and can adjust the blend within agreed parameters to optimize for cost, time zone, or capability requirements.

5. Quality Assurance Framework

All delivery centers operate under Meridian's unified Quality Assurance Framework (QAF), which ensures consistent delivery quality regardless of location:

- Meridian Delivery Methodology -- Standardized delivery lifecycle (Initiate, Design, Build, Test, Deploy, Operate) with mandatory quality gates at each phase transition.
- Peer Reviews -- All deliverables undergo peer review by a qualified reviewer not on the engagement team. Code reviews are mandatory for all software deliverables.
- Quality Metrics -- Tracked monthly: defect density, on-time delivery rate (target: >95%), client satisfaction score (target: >4.5/5.0), rework rate (target: <5%).
- Independent Quality Audits -- Meridian's Quality Assurance team conducts random audits of 10% of active engagements per quarter. Findings are reported to the Quality Steering Committee.
- Client Feedback -- Structured feedback collected at project milestones and engagement completion. Net Promoter Score (NPS) tracked quarterly (current: +62).
- Continuous Improvement -- Monthly quality review boards at each delivery center. Root cause analysis for all engagements scoring below 4.0/5.0 on client satisfaction.

6. Follow-the-Sun Operating Model

Meridian's follow-the-sun model leverages the geographic distribution of our delivery centers to provide extended or continuous coverage:

- Zone 1 -- Americas (Costa Rica, Mexico, onshore U.S./Canada): UTC-8 to UTC-5. Coverage: 7 AM - 8 PM ET.
- Zone 2 -- EMEA (Poland, Romania, onshore UK/Europe): UTC+0 to UTC+2. Coverage: 8 AM - 7 PM CET.
- Zone 3 -- APAC (India, Philippines, onshore Australia): UTC+5:30 to UTC+11. Coverage: 8 AM - 8 PM IST.
- Combined coverage: Near-continuous 20+ hour operational window for development, support, and managed service engagements.
- Handoff Protocols: Standardized shift handoff procedures with documented work-in-progress status, blocking issues, and next actions. Average handoff time: 15 minutes.
- For 24/7 operations (managed SOC, critical production support): Full round-the-clock staffing with rotating shifts across all three zones.

7. Data Sovereignty and Regulatory Controls

Meridian implements robust data sovereignty controls to ensure compliance with client and regulatory requirements:

- Data Residency Guarantees -- Client data can be restricted to specific geographic regions. EU-only delivery available through Poland and Romania centers for GDPR-sensitive engagements.
- Network Segmentation -- Each client environment is logically isolated with dedicated virtual networks, access controls, and audit logging.
- Access Restrictions -- Geofencing capabilities restrict data access to approved delivery center locations. VPN with multi-factor authentication required for all remote access.
- Background Checks -- All delivery center staff undergo comprehensive background checks including criminal history, education verification, and employment history verification. Enhanced vetting (including credit and

government clearance) for regulated industry clients.

- Regulatory Compliance -- Individual centers maintain additional certifications as required: HIPAA (for U.S. healthcare), PCI DSS (for payment card data), FedRAMP (for U.S. government), IRAP (for Australian government).

8. Talent and Capability Profile

The GDN workforce comprises highly skilled professionals with strong technical and domain expertise:

- Average experience: 6.8 years across the GDN.
- Advanced degrees: 42% hold master's degrees or above.
- Cloud certifications: 4,200+ across AWS, Azure, and GCP (including 380 Professional/Expert level).
- Agile certifications: 2,800+ (CSM, PSM, SAFe).
- Annual training investment: Average 120 hours per professional per year.
- Attrition rate: 11.2% (well below the industry average of 18-22% in delivery center markets).
- Internal mobility: 15% of GDN staff rotate to onshore client sites annually for knowledge transfer and career development.

9. Scalability and Surge Capacity

The GDN is designed to scale rapidly in response to client demand:

- Standard ramp-up: 50-100 additional professionals within 4-6 weeks for established capability areas.
- Rapid ramp-up: Up to 200 professionals within 8 weeks using pre-qualified bench resources and strategic staffing partnerships.
- Bench capacity: Approximately 800 professionals (6% of GDN headcount) are maintained on bench at any time, pre-trained in high-demand skill areas.
- Strategic staffing partners: Pre-qualified relationships with 8 staffing firms across India, Philippines, Poland, and Romania for surge capacity beyond bench.
- Facility headroom: All delivery centers operate at 70-80% physical capacity, with expansion space available for 20-30% growth without new facility buildout.
- Maximum demonstrated ramp: 350 professionals onboarded in 10 weeks for a global financial services client's cloud migration program (2024).